

DR. KARI OTTEBURN

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

International political economy; social dimensions of global economic governance and trade and investment; EU trade and regulatory policy; global governance institutions and international relations; business and human rights; access to remedy; political power of global corporations; private, informal and multi-stakeholder governance; corporate accountability and due diligence regulation; sustainability governance

CURRENT POSITION

Senior Researcher (Post-Doctoral Fellow)

Leuven Centre for Global Governance Studies, KU Leuven | September 2024 – Present

Full-time position researching corporate accountability, global sustainability and global economic governance, EU trade and regulatory policy, and transnational private authority. Lead researcher in FWO-funded project on due diligence implementation (MEDIATE, 2024-2028) and member of coordination teams for Jean Monnet Networks on transatlantic engagement (TANDEM, 2026-29) and EU external action (EU-RENEW, 2023-2026).

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Faculty of Social Sciences

KU Leuven, Belgium | September 2018 – September 2024

Dissertation: 'To the Whetstone or the Drawing Board? Access to Remedy for Extraterritorial Business-Related Human Rights Violations'

Supervision: Prof. Dr. Kolja Raube, Dr. Axel Marx (co-supervisor)

Jury: Prof. Dr. Claire Bright (NOVA School of Law), Dr. Alice Evans (King's College London), Prof. Dr. Huib Huyse (KU Leuven), Prof. Dr. Geert Van Calster (KU Leuven)

M.A. in European Studies (Module: Asia-Europe Interactions and Comparisons)

KU Leuven, Belgium | September 2017 – 2018

Thesis: 'The Elephant in the Room: Indian Business Perceptions of the India-EU Bilateral Trade and Investment Agreement'

Magna cum laude

B.A. in (South Asian) Religion

Illinois Wesleyan University, United States | August 2005 – May 2009

Honors Thesis: 'A Place of Paramount Peace': The Unofficial Hindu Nationalism of an Officially Peaceful Movement'

Magna cum laude, with research honors

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Lecturer (Course Coordinator and Instructor) – Global Environmental Politics (6 ECTS)

Faculty of Social Sciences, KU Leuven | Academic Year 2025-2026

Master's-level course taught across five graduate programmes (Master of Advanced Studies in European Policies and Public Administration, Master of European Studies: Transnational and Global Perspectives, Master of International Politics, Master in de politieke wetenschappen, Master of Cultural Anthropology and Development Studies, Master of Geography). Course covers global governance institutions, international environmental agreements, multi-stakeholder processes, and policy implementation challenges.

Supervisor – International Law Legal Clinic (coordinated by Prof. Dr. Jan Wouters)

Faculty of Law, KU Leuven | Academic Year 2025-2026

Supervise Master's-level students of international law in carrying out their legal clinic projects related to business and human rights, international access to remedy, and international cooperation concerning corporate accountability for extraterritorial abuses of human rights.

Lecturer (ad hoc) – EU Policymaking and EU Trade

Various institutions (see Guest Lectures below) | 2022 – present

Regularly deliver stand-alone lectures to students participating in study abroad programmes on EU Institutions and Decision-Making, EU Trade Policy, and EU Autonomous Measures: Geopolitics and Evolving Priorities.

Teaching Assistant – EU Trade Policy (6 ECTS)

Master of European Studies, KU Leuven | January 2019 – May 2021

Taught seminars on EU trade agreements, trade and sustainable development chapters, private governance, and EU trade policy-making processes. Supervised student research projects on EU trade negotiations and implementation.

Guest Lectures

- "EU Autonomous Measures: Geopolitics and Evolving Priorities", Irish College Leuven, March 2026
- "The EU and Global Trade Governance: Between Values and Interests in Geopolitical Times", Euro-Asia Summer School, Barcelona, September 2025
- "Fitting Values into Strategic Autonomy: The EU in the Promotion of Human and Labour Rights Beyond Borders", Euro-Asia Summer School, Barcelona, September 2025
- "International Organizations: Internal Challenges, External Shocks and Rising Informality", University of Georgia Law Global Governance Summer School, May 2025
- "EU Institutions and Decision-Making", Irish College Leuven, multiple annually, 2022 - present
- "Qualitative Analysis and Process Tracing", M.A. European Studies, KU Leuven, Fall Semester 2020-2023 (annual)

- "Global Governance of Trade: Voluntary Governmental Rules and Business and Human Rights", International Law and Global Governance Summer School, May 2023
- "Global Governance of Trade: Voluntary Governmental Rules", M.A. European Studies, KU Leuven, Spring Semester 2019-2022 (annual)
- "The EU as a Trade Power in a Global Non-Trade Moment: Recent Developments in Interactions with South Asia", ETEE Winter School, October 2020
- "European and South Asian Regionalism", M.A. European Studies, Spring Semester 2019, 2020, 2021

RECENT SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

Oxfam Coalition Meeting – September 2026

Invited speaker on the Institutional Design of Supervisory Authorities for the CSDDD

OECD Responsible Business Conduct Forum – June-July 2026

Invited speaker on the role of OECD National Contact Points in Access to Remedy

ETUC – ETUI – Seminar on a new labour-centred trade paradigm – June 2026

Invited speaker on Making Trade Work for Labour and Sustainability in a Geopolitical World

RESEARCH FUNDING AND PROJECTS

FWO SBO Project "Moderating due diligence through intermediary engagement" (MEDIATE), 2024 – 2028

Co-first author of successful research proposal for Strategic Basic Research funding from Research Foundation Flanders (FWO). Lead researcher examining the role of intermediaries (including government agencies, consulting firms, voluntary sustainability standards, trade unions and others) in implementing mandatory due diligence legislation. Member of project coordination team managing multi-partner research consortium and multi-stakeholder advisory council.

Jean Monnet Network "Transatlantic Network for Dialogue, Education and Multidisciplinary Research" (TANDEM), 2026 – 2029

Member of project management team; network contributor examining EU-US engagement on trade and sustainability governance.

Jean Monnet Policy Debate Network "EU Research and Education Network on Europe in the World" (EU-RENEW), 2023-2026

Co-Manager of network involving 15+ institutions across Europe. Coordinated network research outputs and multi-stakeholder dialogues. Co-edited open-access textbook *Europe in the World* and co-developed Massive Open Online Course on EU External Affairs. Managed network communications and stakeholder engagement.

Jean Monnet Network "EU Research and Education Network on Foreign Policy Issues: Values and Democracy" (EU-VALUES), 2024 – 2027

Network contributor; member of coordination team.

EU H2020 Project "The European Union and the Future of the Global Governance – Future Trends and Scenarios" (GLOBE), 2019-2022

Lead researcher for work packages on Trade and Sustainable Development and on Innovative Governance Models. Lead coordinator for Dissemination work package. Conducted comparative institutional analysis across multiple global governance regimes and contributed to final report projecting future scenarios for international organizations.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Marx, Axel and **Otteburn, Kari** (co-first authors) (2026) How due diligence transforms private sustainability governance: The case of the Global Organic Textile Standard. *Global Policy*. doi: <http://doi.org/10.1111/1758-5899.70188>

Otteburn, Kari (2025) Pathways to remedy for corporate human rights abuse: a qualitative comparative analysis of the institutional design of the OECD national contact points. *International Journal of Human Rights*, 29(8), 1410–1435. doi:10.1080/13642987.2025.2460185

Jordana, Jacint; Holesch, Adam; Schmitt, Lewin; Roger, Charles; Tokhi, Alexandros; **Otteburn, Kari**; Saz-Carranza, Saz; Vandendriessche, Marie; Zürn, Michael; Coen, David; Levi-Faur, David; Marx, Axel. (2024) Institutional Transformations of Global Governance–Key Challenges for International Organisations. *International Review of Public Policy*, 6(3). doi: 10.4000/13gfw

Otteburn, Kari (2023). Reaching the limit: access to remedy through nonjudicial mechanisms for victims of business-related human rights abuses. *International Journal of Human Rights*. doi: 10.1080/13642987.2023.2251002

Otteburn, Kari (2023). All in favour? Indian business interests and the India-EU FTA. *Asia Europe Journal*. doi: 10.1007/s10308-023-00672-y

Otteburn, Kari; Marx, Axel (2022). A Glass Half-Empty or Half-Full? An Assessment of the Labour Provisions in the CAI from Chinese and European Perspectives. *Journal of World Investment and Trade*, 23 (4), 601-627. doi: 10.1163/22119000-12340262 Open Access

Marx, Axel; Pertiwi, Sukmawani Bela; Depoorter, Charline; Hoornick, Michiel; Mursitama, Tirta Nugraha; **Otteburn, Kari**; Arnakim, Lili Yulyadi. (2021). What role for regional organizations in goal-setting global governance? An analysis of the role of the European Union and ASEAN in the Sustainable Development Goals. *Global Public Policy and Governance*, 1, 421-445. doi: 10.1007/s43508-021-00027-6 Open Access

Otteburn, Kari (2021). Surprising Reversal: Workers Obtain Remedy at the Belgian National Contact Point for the OECD Guidelines in Rare Agreement. *International Labor Rights Case Law*, 7 (2), 136-138. doi: 10.1163/24056901-07020003

Otteburn, Kari (2021). No Guidance at the Belgian OECD National Contact Point: Can Mediation Alone "Further the Effectiveness of the Guidelines"? *International Labor Rights Case Law*, 7 (1), 33-38. doi: 10.1163/24056901-07010007

Edited Volumes

Otteburn, Kari; Han, JeongHun; Marx, Axel (eds.) (forthcoming January 2027) *Europe-Asia Connectivities in Geopolitical Times*. Palgrave Macmillan.

Marx, Axel; Van Calster, Geert; Wouters, Jan; **Otteburn, Kari**; Lica, Diana (eds.) (2022) *Research Handbook on Global Governance, Business and Human Rights*. Cheltenham: Edward Elgar.

Book Chapters

Marx, Axel; **Otteburn, Kari**; Wouters, Jan (forthcoming 2027) Corporate Sustainability and the EU Due Diligence Directive. In: Luca Rubini (ed.) *Research Handbook on Unilateral Measures in Trade, Investment and Economic Law*. Cheltenham, UK: Edward Elgar.

Otteburn, Kari; Marx, Axel. (2025) The International Labour Organization. In: J. Chaisse, C. Hermann (Eds.) *The International Law of Economic Integration*. Oxford, UK: Oxford University Press.

Otteburn, Kari; Marx, Axel; Wouters, Jan. (2025) From Formal Intergovernmental Organizations to Informal Law-Making and Intergovernmental Organizations. In: J. Jordana, A. Marx, M. Vandendriessche, J. Wouters (Eds.) *Institutions of Global Governance*, Chapt. 4. Cheltenham, UK: Edward Elgar.

Pertiwi, Bela; Marx, Axel; Depoorter, Charline; Mursitama, Tirta Nugraha; **Otteburn, Kari**; Arnakim, Lili Yukyadi. (2025) The Challenges of Governing Sustainable Development Through Goals: Prioritization and Coordination in Europe and Southeast Asia. In: J. Jordana, A. Marx, M. Vandendriessche, J. Wouters (Eds.) *Institutions of Global Governance*, Chapt. 14. Cheltenham, UK: Edward Elgar.

Otteburn, Kari (2025) Degrees of Remedy: Understanding Remedy Outcomes at the OECD National Contact Points. In: Davaanyam, Otgontuya and Krajewski, Markus (Eds.) *Corporate Human Rights Responsibility in OECD Case Law: Actors, Issues, Responsibilities and Remedies*. Springer. (open access) doi: 10.1007/978-3-031-75717-4_6

Otteburn, K., Marx, A. (2022). Seeking remedies for corporate human rights abuses: What is the contribution of OECD National Contact Points? In: A. Marx, G. Van Calster, J. Wouters, K. Otteburn, D. Lica (Eds.), *Research Handbook on Global Governance, Business and Human Rights*, Chapt. 11, (229-253). (Research Handbooks on Globalisation and the Law). Cheltenham, UK: Edward Elgar. doi: 10.4337/9781788979832.00018

Marx, Axel; **Otteburn, Kari**; Lica, Diana; Van Calster, Geert; Wouters, Jan. (2022). Global Governance of Business and Human Rights: An Introduction. In: *Research Handbook on Global Governance, Business and Human Rights*, Chapt. 1, (1-21). (Research Handbooks on Globalisation and the Law series). Cheltenham, UK: Edward Elgar. doi: 10.4337/9781788979832.00008

Marx, Axel, **Otteburn, Kari**. (2022). The global governance of development. In: *Handbook on the Politics of International Development*, Chapt. 6, (91-106). Cheltenham: Edward Elgar.

Commissioned Reports and Policy Briefs

Bright, C., Elliott, J., Gonzalez De Aguinaga, S., Huyse, H., Marx, A., **Otteburn, K.**, & Pietropaoli, I. (2026). *Overcoming Transposition Challenges of the CSDDD, Some Best Practices*. Policy Brief 2. Transposing the CSDDD – Navigating Legal Uncertainties amidst the Omnibus proposal and Implementation Challenges. NOVA Centre on Business, Human Rights and the Environment / BIICL / Leuven Centre for Global Governance Studies / HIVA.

Bright, C., Elliott, J., Gonzalez De Aguinaga, S., Huyse, H., Marx, A., **Otteburn, K.**, & Pietropaoli, I. (2026). *Accompanying Measures*. Policy Brief 3. Transposing the CSDDD – Navigating Legal Uncertainties amidst the Omnibus proposal and Implementation Challenges. NOVA Centre on Business, Human Rights and the Environment / BIICL / Leuven Centre for Global Governance Studies / HIVA.

Bright, C., Elliott, J., Ganser, A., Gonzalez De Aguinaga, S., Hylander, M., Huyse, H., Marx, A., **Otteburn, K.**, Pietropaoli, I., Rühmkorf, A., & Uvarova, O. (2026). *From Transposition to Transformation: Designing and Enforcing Effective National HREDD Laws*. NOVA Centre on Business, Human Rights and the Environment / BIICL / Leuven Centre for Global Governance Studies / HIVA / Westfälische Hochschule / Global Rights Compliance.

Bright, C., **Otteburn, K.**, Huyse, H., Marx, A. (2025). Study on the operational implementation and transposition in Belgium of the Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive (2024/1760) of the European Union. Commissioned by the Federal Public Service Economy, Belgium.

Bright, C., Elliott, J., Gonzalez De Aguinaga, S., Huyse, H., Marx, A., **Otteburn, K.**, Pietropaoli, I. (2025). Implementing the CSDDD: Lessons learnt from the comparative experiences. Policy Brief 1. Transposing the CSDDD – Navigating Legal Uncertainties amidst the Omnibus proposal and Implementation Challenges. NOVA Centre on Business, Human Rights and the Environment, British Institute of International and Comparative Law, Leuven Centre for Global Governance Studies, and HIVA Research Institute for Work and Society.

Jordana, J., Saz, A., Marx, A., Holesch, A., Vandendriessche, M., Coen, D., Levi-Faur, D., Roger, C., Zürn, M., Tokhi, A., **Otteburn, K.**, Schmitt, L., Moreno Villar, C. (2023). Trends in Global Governance and Future Scenarios 2030. GLOBE Report, Institut Barcelona d'Estudis Internacionals. doi: 10.31009/ibei.2023.01

Depoorter, C., Marx, A., **Otteburn, K.** (2021). Multistakeholder Governance. Globe Project: Horizon 2020 Framework Programme of the European Union.

Otteburn, K., Marx, A. (2020). Shortcomings of Current Governance and Institutional Models. GLOBE Project: Horizon 2020 Framework Programme of the European Union.

Marx, A., **Otteburn, K.**, Hegde, V., et al. (2019). Mapping of the Trade and Development Global Regimes and Institutions. GLOBE Project: Horizon 2020 Framework Programme of the European Union.

Other Publications

Otteburn, Kari (2025) 'Review: Vigilantes Beyond Borders: NGOs as Enforcers of International Law, by Mette Eilstrup-Sangiovanni and J.C. Sharman' *Revue critique de droit international privé*.

Otteburn, Kari; Marx, Axel. (2023). Seeking Corporate Accountability: Progress and Pitfalls of Mandatory Due Diligence. EU-RENEW. Blog.

Otteburn, Kari; Marx, Axel. (2023) Open, sustainable and assertive... and incremental: Assessing labour provisions in the CAI. EU-RENEW. Blog.

Otteburn, Kari. (2021). The OECD National Contact Points: A Promising External Regulator for Voluntary Sustainability Standards?. Nova School of International Law. Blog.

Depoorter, Charline; Marx, Axel; **Otteburn, Kari**. (2021). Potential and Limitations of VSS as Global Governance Instruments. Insights from a case study of forest certification. GLOBE. Blog.

Otteburn, Kari. (2020). Development for what? The evolving objectives of global development governance. GLOBE. Blog.

Otteburn, Kari. (2020). The changing face of global trade. GLOBE. Blog.

FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS, AND SCHOLARSHIPS

BICC&I and Emirates Scriptum Award for Best Master's Thesis, 2019

University Immersion Program Scholarship, Sichuan University, 2018

Hindi Language Fellowship, American Institute of Indian Studies, AY 2009-2010

American Institute of Indian Studies' Award for 'Best Research Project', 2010

Donald R. Koehn Memorial Award for 'Excellence in the Humanities', 2009

Critical Language Scholarship, Council of American Overseas Research Centers and U.S. Department of State, 2008

Technos International Scholarship, Tanaka Foundation, 2007

ADDITIONAL METHODOLOGICAL TRAINING

Process Tracing, ECPR Winter School, 2021

Qualitative Comparative Analysis, ECPR Winter School, 2021

Introduction to R, FLAMES, 2021

Method in Data Collection, FLAMES, 2021

Using NVIVO for qualitative data analysis, FLAMES, 2020

LANGUAGES

English (native), Hindi (professional proficiency), French (professional proficiency), Urdu (intermediate), Dutch (basic)

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Junior Research Fellow

Leuven Centre for Global Governance Studies, KU Leuven | October 2018 – September 2024

Conducted research on EU trade policy, global governance institutions, and corporate accountability mechanisms. Member of research team for H2020 Project GLOBE (2019-2022), with a leading role for Work Packages on Trade and Sustainable Development and on Innovative Governance Models. Responsible for communication, dissemination, and exploitation strategy for EU H2020 Project RECONNECT (2018-2022), which received special recognition by the European Commission. Junior member of coordination team.